FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SEEDS, AGRICULTURAL

This specification was approved on the above date by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies, and shall become effective not later than 10 June 1950, for use in procurement initiated on or after that date. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation by the Administrator, General Services Administration.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Kinds.—Agricultural seeds covered by this specification shall be of the kinds shown in table I and any desired mixtures, as specified. (See 3.2.2 and 6.1.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications. — There are no other specifications applicable to this specification except those referenced in section 7 by individual departments.

2.2 Other publications. — The following publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Governmental:

Service and Regulatory Announcements No. 156 of the Production and Marketing Administration, United States Department of Agriculture; The Federal Seed Act and the Rules and Regulations thereunder.

State Noxious-Weed Seed Requirements Recognized in the Administration of the Federal Seed Act issued by the Production and Marketing Administration, United States Department of Agriculture.

Regulations for Inspection and Certification of Certain Agricultural Commodities and Products Thereof, (7CFR, Part 68), issued by the Secretary of Agriculture.

Applicable State seed laws.

(Copies of Federal specifications and the Federal Specifications Index may be obtained upon application accompanied by postal note, money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

(Copies of Service and Regulatory Announcements No. 156, State Noxious-Weed Seed Requirements Recognized in the Administration of the Federal Seed Act, and the Regulations for Inspection and Certification of Certain Agricultural Commodities and Products Thereof may be obtained from the Grain Branch, Production and Marketing Administration, United States Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.

(Copies of applicable State seed laws may be obtained by writing the State Department of Agriculture in the State concerned.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Federal Seed Act and State seed laws. —Agricultural seeds covered by this specification shall conform to the requirements of the Federal Seed Act and to the State seed laws as applicable.

3.2 Quality requirements. — Agricultural seeds shall conform to the quality requirements shown in table I.

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TABLE I.—*Quality requirements for agricultural seeds*

Name of seed	Percent pure seed	Percent germination and hard seed	Percent weed seed
Alfalfa—*Medicago sativa*	99	90	.50
Bahia grass—*Paspalum notatum*	72	70	.50
Barley—*Hordeum vulgare*	99	90	.50
Bean:			
Adzuki—*Phaseolus angularis*	99	90	.00
Field—*Phaseolus vulgaris*	99	90	.00
Mung—*Phaseolus aureus*	99	90	.00
Velvet—*Stizolobium utile*	99	80	.00
Beet, field—*Beta vulgaris*	97	75	.00
Bentgrass:			
Astoria—*Agrostis tenuis var.*	95	90	.50
Colonial—*Agrostis tenuis*	95	90	.50
Creeping—*Agrostis palustris*	95	90	.50
Highland—*Agrostis tenuis var.*	95	90	.50
Velvet—*Agrostis canina*	95	90	.50
Bermuda grass—*Cynodon dactylon*	97	85	1.00
Bluegrass:			
Annual—*Poa annua*	80	80	2.00
Canada—*Poa compressa*	80	80	1.00
Kentucky—*Poa pratensis*	85	80	1.00
Rough—*Poa trivialis*	85	80	1.00
Wood—*Poa nemoralis*	80	80	1.00
Brome:			
Mountain—*Bromus marginatus*	92	85	1.00
Smooth—*Bromus inermis*	92	85	1.00
Broomcorn—*Sorghum vulgare technicum*	98	85	.50
Buckwheat—*Fagopyrum esculentum*	97	85	1.00
Canary grass, Reed—*Phalaris arundinacea*	96	80	.50
Carpet grass—*Axonopus affinis*	92	90	.50
Chickpea—*Cicer arietinum*	99	90	.00
Clovers:			
Alsike—*Trifolium hybridum*	97	90	1.00
Alyce—*Alysicarpus vaginalis*	98	90	1.00
Berseem—*Trifolium alexandrinum*	98	90	.50
Bur, spotted—*Medicago arabica* (in bur)	80	90	.50
Bur, spotted—*Medicago arabica* (out of bur)	98	90	.50
Bur—*Medicago hispida* (in bur)	90	90	.50
Bur—*Medicago hispida* (out of bur)	98	90	.50
Cluster—*Trifolium glomeratum*	95	85	1.00
Crimson—*Trifolium incarnatum*	98	85	.80
Ladino—*Trifolium repens*	95	90	1.00
Persian—*Trifolium resupinatum*	95	85	1.00
Red—*Trifolium pratense*	98	90	.50
Sour—*Melilotus indica*	98	90	.50
Strawberry—*Trifolium fragiferum*	97	90	1.00
Subterranean—*Trifolium subterraneum*	99	90	.50
Suckling—*Trifolium dubium*	90	85	1.00
Sweet:			
White Blossom—*Melilotus alba*	98	88	1.00
Yellow Blossom—*Melilotus officinalis*	98	88	1.00
White—*Trifolium repens*	95	90	1.00

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TABLE I.—*Quality requirements for agricultural seeds (continued)*

Name of seed	Percent pure seed	Percent germination and hard seed	Percent weed seed
Corn:			
Field—*Zea mays*	99	90	.00
Pop—*Zea mays everta*	99	90	.00
Cotton—*Gossypium hirsutum*	99	85	.00
Cowpea—*Vigna sinensis*	98	85	.00
Crested dogtail—*Cynosurus cristatus*	98	80	.50
Crotalaria—*Crotalaria intermedia*	99	80	.50
Crotalaria—*Crotalaria lanceolata*	99	80	.50
Crotalaria—*Crotalaria spectabilis*	99	80	.50
Dallis grass—*Paspalum dilatatum*	70	70	1.00
Fescue:			
Meadow—*Festuca elatior*	97	90	2.00
Red, Chewings—*Festuca rubra var.*	97	80	.50
Sheep—*Festuca ovina*	96	85	.50
Tall—*Festuca elatior var. arundinacea*	97	90	2.00
Flax—*Linum usitatissimum*	97	85	.50
Guinea grass—*Panicum maximum*	30	35	1.00
Hemp—*Cannabis sativa*	98	85	.25
Johnson grass—*Sorghum halepense*	98	85	.50
Kudzu—*Pueraria thunbergiana*	99	70	.50
Lespedeza:			
Sericea or Chinese—*Lespedeza cuneata*	98	90	1.00
Common and Kobe—*Lespedeza striata*	96	90	1.00
Korean—*Lespedeza stipulacea*	97	90	1.00
Lupine:			
Blue—*Lupinus angustifolius*	99	90	.00
White—*Lupinus albus*	99	90	.00
Yellow—*Lupinus luteus*	99	90	.00
Meadow foxtail—*Alopecurus pratensis*	90	80	.50
Medick, black—*Medicago lupulina*	98	90	.50
Millet:			
Browntop—*Panicum fasciculatum*	96	70	.50
Foxtail, German, Hungarian, or Golden—*Setaria italica*	98	90	.50
Japanese—*Echinochloa crusgalli frumentacea*	97	90	.50
Pearl—*Pennisetum glaucum*	98	85	.50
Proso—*Panicum miliaceum*	98	85	.50
Molasses grass—*Melinis minutiflora*	50	50	1.00
Oats—*Avena sativa*	98	90	.10
Oatgrass, tall—*Arrhenatherum elatius*	85	80	1.00
Orchard grass—*Dactylis glomerata*	85	85	1.50
Peanuts—*Arachis hypogaea*	99	80	.00
Peas, field—*Pisum sativum arvense*	99	90	.00
Rape, Dwarf Essex, Winter—*Brassica napus*	99	90	.50
Redtop—*Agrostis alba*	92	90	1.00
Rescue grass—*Bromus catharticus*	95	85	1.00
Rhodes grass—*Chloris gayana*	60	60	1.00
Rice—*Oryza sativa*	99	90	.50
Rough pea—*Lathyrus hirsutus*	98	90	.00
Rye—*Secale cereale*	97	85	.10
Ryegrass:			
Italian—*Lolium multiflorum*	98	90	.50
Perennial—*Lolium perenne*	98	90	.50

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TABLE I.—*Quality requirements for agricultural seeds (continued)*

Name of seed	Percent pure seed	Percent germination and hard seed	Percent weed seed
Sainfoin—*Onobrychis viciaefolia*	98	70	.50
Sesbania—*Sesbania exaltata*	99	90	.25
Sorghum:			
Grain—*Sorghum vulgare*	98	85	.50
Sweet (Sorgo)—*Sorghum vulgare*	98	85	.50
Soybean—*Glycine max*	98	85	.00
Sudan grass—*Sorghum vulgare sudanense*	98	80	.50
Sunflower (Cult)—*Helianthus annuus*	99	90	.00
Sweet vernalgrass—*Anthoxanthum odoratum*	90	80	.50
Timothy—*Phleum pratense*	99	90	.50
Trefoil, Big—*Lotus uliginosus*	98	80	1.00
Trefoil, Birdsfoot—*Lotus corniculatus*	96	90	1.00
Velvet grass—*Holcus lanatus*	95	85	.50
Vetch:			
Common—*Vicia sativa*	97	90	.50
Hairy—*Vicia villosa*	97	90	.50
Hungarian—*Vicia pannonica*	97	90	.50
Monantha—*Vicia articulata*	97	90	.50
Narrowleaf—*Vicia angustifolia*	97	90	.50
Purple—*Vicia atropurpurea*	97	90	.50
Woollypod—*Vicia dasycarpa*	97	90	.50
Wheat—*Triticum spp.*	99	90	.10
Wheatgrass:			
Crested, fairway—*Agropyron cristatum*	95	85	.50
Crested, standard—*Agropyron cristatum*	95	85	.50
Slender—*Agropyron trachycaulum*	95	85	.50
Western (Bluestem)—*Agropyron smithii*	80	80	2.00

3.2.1 *Noxious-weed seeds.* — Agricultural seeds covered by this specification shall in no event contain more than 45 per pound of the following-named noxious-weed seed; bindweed, Canada thistle, dodder, perennial sowthistle, quackgrass, leafy spurge, whitetop, Johnson grass, and Russian knapweed.

3.2.2 *Mixtures.*—Mixtures of seeds shall be based upon the definite requirements for each kind of seed component, utilizing the name, percentage of pure seed, percentage of germination, and percentage of weed seeds given in table I. (See 6.1 and table II for example.)

3.3 Rejection.—Seeds furnished under this specification which fail to meet the test requirements (allowing tolerances as provided under the Federal Seed Act) shall either be rejected or subjected to deductions in accordance with 3.4.

3.4 Deductions.—Deductions in price shall be based on the results of tests with tolerances being allowed, as compared to the percentage of pure seed, weed seed, and germination specified. The discount for straight kinds shall be as follows:

(1) *Germination.*—Deduction of 2 percent for each percent of germination that the seed falls below the requirements after the allowance of the tolerance.

(2) *Pure seed.*—Deduction of 2 percent for each 0.5 percent of pure seed that the seed falls below the requirements after allowance of tolerance.

(3) *Weed seeds.*—Deduction of 1 percent for each 0.20 percent or fraction thereof of weeds in excess of the amount specified after allowance of tolerances.

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3.5 Workmanship. — Agricultural seeds shall be thoroughly recleaned, and of uniformly good quality and appearance throughout each lot.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling and inspection.—Agricultural seeds shall be sampled and inspected by the procuring agency or an authorized representative at the time and place specified by the procuring agency in accordance with the Regulations for Inspection and Certification of Certain Agricultural Commodities and Products Thereof (7CFR68) issued by the Secretary of Agriculture.

4.2 Tests.—Purity and germination and noxious-weed seed tests shall be conducted in accordance with the methods prescribed in Service and Regulatory Announcements No. 156.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. — Unless otherwise specified, commercial packages are acceptable.

5.2 Packing.—The subject commodity shall be prepared for shipment to permit acceptance by carrier for transportation at the lowest applicable rate, and to afford maximum protection from normal hazards of transportation.

5.3 Marking.—Unless otherwise specified, the containers shall be labeled as required by the Federal Seed Act or applicable State seed law.

6. NOTES

6.1 The following example is given to show the method for determining requirements for mixtures from the requirements for each ingredient:

TABLE II.—*Work table for determining requirements for mixtures from the requirements of each ingredient*

Weight in pounds of each ingredient	Percent by weight	Commodity	Percent pure seed specified	Minimum percent pure seed to be in mixture	Maximum percent weeds specified	Maximum percent weeds to be in mixture	Minimum percent germination specified
100	62½	Ky. Bluegrass	85.00	[1]53.13	1.00	0.625	80.00
50	31¼	Redtop	92.00	[2]28.75	1.00	0.3125	90.00
10	6¼	White Clover	96.00	[3] 6.00	1.00	0.0625	90.00 (hard seed included)
Total 160				Total weed seeds		[4]1.00	

Purchasers should require the following from the above formula

	Pure seed	Minimum germination
	Percent	*Percent*
Ky. Bluegrass	[1]53.13	80
Redtop	[2]28.75	90
White Clover	[3] 6.00	90 (hard seed included)
Weeds not more than	[4] 1.00	----------

6.2 The examples on the next page are given to indicate the manner in which invitations for bids should be submitted.

6.3 This specification does not include all kinds and qualities of agricultural seeds that are commercially available but is intended to cover the kinds and quality generally suitable for Government requirements.

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Item No.	Articles or Services	Quantity	Unit	Unit Price	Amount Dollars	Amount Cents
1	Seed. Crested Wheatgrass (*Agropyron cristatum*). The pure seed to be not less than 95 percent and the germination not less than 85 percent. The percentage of weed seed to be not more than 0.50 percent.					
2	Grass seed mixture. To contain the following minimum percent pure seed of each kind and minimum germinations as indicated.					
	53% Pure Ky. Bluegrass seed 80%—Germination					
	28% Pure Redtop 90%—Germination					
	6% Pure White Clover 90%—Germination (including hard seed)					
	The percentage of weeds for the mixture to be not more than 1.00%.					

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following departmental specifications and other publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

7.2 Navy.

7.2.1 *Applicable specifications and other publications.*—

Navy Department Specification:

General Specifications for Inspection of Material.

Bureau of Supplies and Accounts Publication:

Navy Shipment Marking Handbook.

(Copies of Federal specifications required for Navy purchases, Navy Department specifications, and the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington 25, D. C., except that Naval activities should make application to the Supply Officer in Command, Naval Supply Center, Norfolk 11, Va. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies of specifications.)

7.2.2 *Marking.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking of interior packages and shipping containers for Navy shipments shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Navy Shipment Marking Handbook.

NAVY: AMCSY

7.3 Air Force.—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking of interior packages and shipping containers for Air Force shipments shall be in accordance with the requirements of U. S. Army Specification 94–40645, Marking; Exterior, Domestic and Export Shipment, by Contractors.

(Copies of specifications required for Air Force purchases may be obtained upon application to the Commanding General, Air Matériel Command, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Dayton, Ohio.)

This specification is a part of Section IV, Part 5, of the Federal Standard Stock Catalog.

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